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Consulting & Strategy Club
SIBM Pune

# CASE I

## PROBLEM

The state tourism authority of Goa has seen a sharp decline in the number of visitors in the last two pandemic years. The authority has decided to hire the Symbi consulting firm for the project. They want to develop the infrastructure and want recommendations for the same.

## FACTS

1. 683 hotels have closed their business in the year 2020-21.
2. 83% decline in International Tourism.
3. Post-pandemic, the bus transport system is in bad shape.
4. 23% reduction in per capita income in the last two years.

## OBJECTIVE

Action plan to increase tourism in Goa in next 6 months.

# CASE I
# Solution Examples

The candidates are expected to give a well rounded and structured answers.
Though multiple answers exist, the below outlines few of them for the panellists' perusal.

**EXAMPLE -**

**1. Identify locations in Goa that are currently being visited by tourists frequently.**
Find out reasons for preference of one destination over another.

**2. Tie up with foreign countries for the tourism of Goa.**
A win-win situation where they would advertise Goa in their country and you may do the same in Goa.

3. **Bringing in a brand ambassador, global icons**.

4. **Increasing visibility of the state by participating in travel fairs, both domestic and international.**

5. **Encourage travel bloggers to prepare an interesting documentary on Goa**.
It would help educate people about the beautiful places which are worth visiting in Goa.

6. **Testimony videos of previous visitors in advertisements**
A cheaper and very impactful mode of advertising the state.

7. **Travel Exhibition**

8. **What can be improved at non-popular destinations to attract tourist footfalls?**

9. **Attract private players in the long term.**

**EXAMPLE APPROACHES**

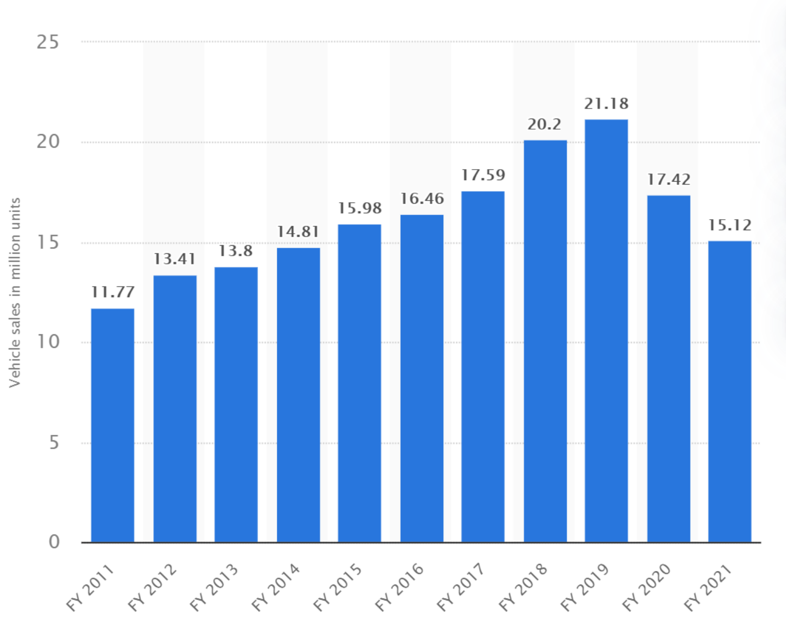
Find different parameters on which the tourism industry depends on.
Find ways of promoting tourism for the state.

# CASE II

**PROBLEM**

Piaggio, an Italian automobile manufacturer, has around 100 retail outlets in India and are willing to expand the network, but are unable to. It has 7 different two-wheeler models designed specifically for the Indian market. Your team is at a meeting with the Country Head of Piaggio (Interviewer). What would you suggest to increase the number of retail outlets to 5000+?

**Two-Wheeler domestic sales – Time series data**




**FACTS**

1. The entry-level offering in the Vespa Piaggio family is the Vespa LX 125 which retails for Rs 96,615.
2. The most expensive Vespa Piaggio on sale is the Vespa VXL 150 priced at Rs 1.25 Lakh.
3. The company lacks a service station set up in India.
4. All the **Vespa** outlets are located in 15 major cities in India and the company has no manufacturing units in India.
5. **0.50%** - market share of Piaggio in 2-wheeler segment

**OBJECTIVE**

**Increase the number of retail outlets in India**

# CASE II:
# Solution Examples

The candidates are expected to give a well-rounded and structured answers.
Though multiple answers exist, the below outlines few of them for the panellists' perusal.

**EXAMPLE -**

1. **Competitor Analysis**
   What other companies are doing in order to expand their network?
   Positioning of Vespa in the automobile industry.
2. **Build manufacturing setup in strategic locations.**
   Parameters to open new retail outlets: Geographic, Demographic, Price of vespa models.
3. **Expansion in new cities relation with pricing/ section of society.**

4. **Growth of automobile industry/ Prediction of sales in next 10 years**
   Impact of covid in the industry

# CASE III

## PROBLEM

Air India is the flag carrier airline of India, headquartered at New Delhi. It is owned by Air India Limited, a government-owned enterprise. Your team of consultants is hired by the Government of India to assist them with a strategy to either revive the debt-laden organisation or if deemed necessary, to liquidate its assets to minimise losses to the company and the impact on livelihood of it's employees.

## FACTS

1. Air India operates a fleet of 130+ Airbus and Boeing aircrafts serving 102 domestic and international destinations.
2. Current debt of the organisation is estimated at INR 60,000 Crores.
3. Air India has one of the best aircraft fleets amongst the other airline operators in India but it's reputation has been poor in recent years because of subpar customer service.
4. Low revenues can be attributed to poor occupancy due to non-competitive pricing along with revenue loss on free and subsidized tickets being issued to various government entities.

## OBJECTIVE

**Action plan to pull the ailing airline out of debt or to prescribe a strategy to liquidate its assets with least economic and social repercussions.**

# CASE III:
# Solution Examples

The candidates are expected to give a well-rounded and structured answers.
Though multiple answers exist, the below outlines few of them for the panellists' perusal.

**EXAMPLE -**

**1. Identify and appoint a passionate leader for the role of CEO and Chairman.**
The leader of Air India needs to be less of a government employee and more of a seasoned business leader capable of crisis management.

**2. Provide autonomy and political insulation to the board**
In order to revive the organisation, the board needs to take some tough decisions which are likely to be faced with much opposition from various entities. This may include decisions to stop providing free and subsidised tickets to political leaders and bureaucrats and also retiring the non performing workforce from the organisation.

3. **Re-building the brand image of Air India**
A systematic program to revive the image of the Airline which has been consistently marred due mishaps and hygiene issues faced by flyers.
Bringing in a young brand ambassador.

4. **Planning sale of the organisation post revival**
Setting a target horizon for turnaround and making the sale only once the signs of a revival are evident. This will fetch far more value for the stakeholders.

**EXAMPLE APPROACHES**

Find the flaws with the current administrative system of the airline. Suggest changes.

Identify and prioritise the factors that are preventing revenue growth. (Kano Model framework)

Compensating the existing employees appropriately in case of asset liquidation.

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# CASE IV

## PROBLEM

Pfizer Inc., an American multinational pharmaceutical and biotechnology corporation headquartered in New York City has been experiencing reduced profitability over the last six months with its Indian arm -Pfizer India. Your company has been appointed by the Pfizer's board to identify the issue and help them get out of the declining profits trend.

## FACTS

1. No problems faced by other players and industry performing well.
2. Decline in profits is stemming majorly from the antibiotics division.
3. The costs for the company have been constant yet there is a decrease in profitability.
4. No major competitor has entered the market in the past 6 months.

## OBJECTIVE

**Action plan to identify the reasons for decreasing profitability and ways to improve the same.**

## APPROACH

Identify the reason for lower profitability is most probably the decrease in sales.

Find whether the decrease in sales is attributable to demand or supply.

Create strategies to increase revenue based on whether it's a demand or supply bottleneck.

# CASE IV
# Solution Examples

The candidates are expected to give a well-rounded and structured answers.
Though multiple answers exist, the below outlines few of them for the panellists' perusal.

**EXAMPLE -**

**1. Identify that the root cause for lowered profitability is lower sales.**

As there is a decrease in sales of the antibiotics, there is a need to identify the major geographies with maximum past sales and study the decline pattern there.

**2. Identify the alternatives which are eating up the sales of Pfizer's devise a plan to counter it.**

Find out customer behaviour and reasons behind inclination towards alternative brands. Collaborate with health practitioners to push sales of Pfizer's medicines.

3. **Evaluate localised marketing campaigns to increase product awareness and sales**

4. **Evaluate whether a competitor is underselling pfizer.**

Need to create a new pricing strategy in the event of competitor underselling. Re-evaluate clients and vendors to ensure reduced costs in future.